



HIM BUSINESS SCHOOL
HOTEL INSTITUTE MONTREUX

COURSE PROPOSAL · 2026-27

CONTEMPORARY HORECA SCENE

Trends · Design & Atmosphere · Neurogastronomy · Technology · World's Best Restaurants & Bars · Budget & Scenography

A 12-week elective that turns the global hospitality scene into a practical business lens — for the next generation of world-ready leaders.

DIGITAL ELECTIVE · EDITION 2026-27

Montreux · 2026

12 weeks · 36 contact hours · English

PASSWORD-PROTECTED COURSE

Course proposal · Hotel Institute Montreux



Why this course — and why now

The global scene is moving faster than the curriculum

“The world's best hospitality is being redefined right now — in Lima, Hong Kong, Dubai, Oslo and São Paulo.

This course brings the frontier into the classroom.”

Nº 1

BAR LEONE, HONG KONG

First Asian bar ever crowned The World's Best Bar (2025)

Nº 1

MAIDO, LIMA

World's Best Restaurant 2025 — Latin America leads the table

51

COUNTRIES AT WORLD CLASS

Global bartending finals 2025, Toronto — won by Norway

\$2M

PROJECTED IMPACT

50 Best week in Lima, Nov 2026 — rankings drive tourism

- Rankings (Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList) have become industry infrastructure: they move tourism, investment and careers.
- Technology — from AI-generated serves to revenue management — is reshaping operations and creativity at the same time.
- Students need a live map of the industry: this course updates every year with the latest lists, ceremonies and case venues.

About the author & course architecture

A practical lens on strategy, concept design and venue economics



HIM ALUMNUS · COURSE LEADER

Egor Tarasenko

Master in Business Management
Hotel Institute Montreux

- **Graduate of the Master in Business Management programme at Hotel Institute Montreux.**

The course is designed as an alumnus contribution: a bridge between Swiss hospitality management and today's global restaurant and bar scene.

- **Focus: strategy, brand and economics of contemporary restaurants and bars.**

From concept and atmosphere engineering to unit economics and ranking strategy.

- **Built on primary industry sources, refreshed annually.**

MICHELIN Guide ceremonies, The 50 Best rankings and stories, GreatList expert reviews, Diageo World Class programmes.

- **Delivery: lectures + case labs + sensory practice + guest speakers.**

Industry practitioners join live or online; students work with real lists and real venues.

Course at a glance

One elective — a full tour of the contemporary scene

12

WEEKS

Semester elective, weeks 1-12 of the term

36

CONTACT HOURS

12 sessions × 3 hours: lecture + case + lab

5+1

MODULES

Five thematic modules and a final pitch day

EN

LANGUAGE

English; key sources and guest speakers

BBA · MIB

AUDIENCE

Bachelor and master students of hospitality & business

4

ASSESSMENT BLOCKS

Participation, field notes, module tasks, final pitch

Positioning: a business-perspective tour of the contemporary Horeca scene — what the world's best venues do, why guests love them, and how rankings, design, science and technology create competitive advantage.

Learning outcomes

What students will be able to do after 12 weeks

01 Navigate the global ranking ecosystem

Michelin, The 50 Best, GreatList, World Class — how they work and how to use them in marketing and strategy.

02 Analyse Horeca trends

Turn macro-trends — experience economy, anti-luxury, mindfulness — into concrete business decisions.

03 Design venue concepts

Interior, light, sound, scent and guest journey (CJM) — atmosphere as a managed product.

04 Apply culinary science & neurogastronomy

Physics & chemistry of flavour, multisensory design of menus, serves and service: from plate weight to sound pairing.

05 Evaluate technology & AI

Reservations, revenue management, kitchen automation, data personalisation — with an ethics filter.

06 Pitch at world level

Develop and defend a venue concept benchmarked against the world's best bars and restaurants.

Course map

Six modules, one arc: from trends to a world-class concept you can build by hand

#	Module	Weeks	Core question	Signature cases
1	Contemporary Horeca Trends	1–3	Where is the industry heading?	50 Best week in Lima; Californios ★★★; Gerbou
2	Venue Design & Atmosphere	4–5	What makes a space unforgettable?	GreatList criteria; Himkok; Hanu Dubai
3	Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience	6–7	How do senses shape taste?	Spence's gastrophysics; World Class multisensory
4	Technology & Automation	8–9	What should be human, what — smart?	AI-inspired serve (Don Julio 1942); Sesto Senso Academy
5	World's Leading Restaurants & Bars	10	Who sets the global standard?	Noma; Maido; Bar Leone; Myojaku; Felice Capasso
6	Budget Realisation & Scenography	11–12	Can you build it with soul — and with what money?	Joi Espresso Bar (built from flea markets); Himkok
+	Mockup + Final Pitch Day	12	Can your venue win the world stage?	Concept decks and paper mockups judged by an expert panel

MODULE 1 · WEEKS 1-3

Contemporary Horeca Trends

Lecture seminars: reading the industry's present and near future

TOPICS

- Experience economy: dining as theatre — chef's tables, counters, storytelling formats.
- Anti-luxury & casualization: «cocktail popolari» — refinement without pretension.
- From sustainability to mindfulness: the Green Star evolves into Michelin's «Mindful Voices».
- Regional cuisines go global: Californios — the world's first three-star Mexican restaurant.
- Gastronomy tourism & city branding: 50 Best week brings ~\$2M of spending to Lima.
- New gravity: Asia, the Middle East and Latin America lead the rankings.
- Hotel F&B; renaissance: hotel bars and dining rooms back on the world lists.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- The 50 Best Restaurants 2026 ceremony — Lima, 4 Nov 2026: the course follows it live.
- Tuju (São Paulo) — Art of Hospitality 2026: fewer guests, menus themed around climate.
- Gerbou (Dubai) — Prix Versailles 2025 for architecture; Emirati cuisine as fine dining.



OPEN-KITCHEN THEATRE

Chef's counters and tasting-menu dramaturgy as a managed business product.

KEY QUESTION

If a venue opens today, which trends will still matter in 2030?

MODULE 2 · WEEKS 4-5

Venue Design & Atmosphere

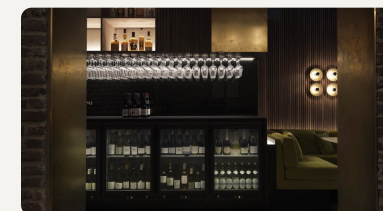
Concept, architecture, interiors, senses — atmosphere as an engineered product

TOPICS

- Concept & narrative: the venue as a story guests retell.
- Space & ergonomics: layout, flow, comfort — a GreatList selection criterion.
- Light, acoustics, scent: the invisible layers of hospitality.
- Tableware & tactile design: weight, texture, temperature.
- Service choreography: rhythm of the evening, «invisible» service.
- Design awards as industry signal: Prix Versailles, Best Bar Design.
- Practice: atmosphere audit of Montreux venues against expert criteria.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- GreatList criteria: design & ergonomics; atmosphere «from scent to music»; full guest CJM.
- Himkok (Oslo) — Best Bar Design: a sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Hanu (Dubai) — Seoul aesthetics: charcoal grills, dark wood, bronze doors.



ARCHITECTURE & LIGHTING

Lighting scenarios, tactile materials, and guest journey ergonomics.

KEY QUESTION

Can atmosphere be measured — and can it be managed like a P&L; line?

MODULE 3 · WEEKS 6-7

Neurogastronomy & Guest Experience

Culinary science & gastrophysics: how the brain constructs flavour from all senses

TOPICS

- Cooking as applied science: Maillard reactions, emulsions, fermentation & controlled testing.
- Gastrophysics basics: crossmodal correspondences (Spence, Oxford).
- Sound & taste: sonic seasoning; music changes perceived flavour.
- Colour, shape and weight of tableware; plating geometry.
- Menu psychology: naming, layout, price anchors, choice architecture.
- Memory, emotion & peak-end rule: designing «Proust moments».
- Sensory lab: a guided blind tasting with controlled variables.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: The Singleton multisensory challenge — cocktail «Between Us» with a custom record sleeve for «That's Amore».
- Tuju: radical personalisation — reading glasses, children's drawing kit, menus of rain and wind.
- Bar Leone: simplicity as a sensory strategy — «cocktails for the people».



MULTISENSORY SERVE

Sound, aromatic smoke, and ceramic weight alter perceived flavour.

KEY QUESTION

What does your venue taste like — before the first bite is served?

MODULE 4 · WEEKS 8-9

Technology & Automation

What should remain human — and what should be smart

TOPICS

- Reservations & waitlist systems; dynamic pricing; revenue management.
- Kitchen & floor automation: robotics, KDS, inventory, waste control.
- Data & CRM: personalisation at the level of a regular guest.
- AI in creativity: concept art, menu R&D, content — and its limits.
- Delivery, dark kitchens and omnichannel models.
- Education tech: academies of spirits & wine (Sesto Senso).
- Ethics & future of work: humane workplaces in a high-pressure industry.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- World Class 2025: Don Julio 1942 challenge — a serve created from an original AI artwork.
- Felice Capasso: Sesto Senso Academy — bartender education as a business model.
- 50 Best «war room»: how rankings themselves use data, voting and media technology.



SMART F&B OPERATIONS

Reservation algorithms and KDS free up staff for human hospitality.

KEY QUESTION

Where does technology amplify hospitality — and where does it kill it?

MODULE 5 · WEEKS 10-12

World's Leading Restaurants & Bars

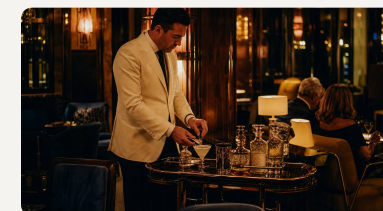
Deep dives into chef philosophies, institutions and venues setting the global standard

TOPICS

- Chefs as authors & researchers: René Redzepi (Noma), Bottura, Humm, Martínez, Royer.
- MICHELIN anatomy: stars, Bib Gourmand, special awards, inspector method.
- The 50 Best Academy: who votes, how lists change markets.
- Bar scene: World's 50 Best Bars, hotel bars, speakeasies.
- World Class: 16 seasons, 450,000+ bartenders, «drink better, not more».
- GreatList geography: Moscow — Dubai — Doha — Bangkok — Shanghai.
- Final pitch: student concepts vs world benchmarks.

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- Maido (Lima) — World's №1 Restaurant 2025; four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Bar Leone (Hong Kong) — World's Best Bar 2025, first Asian №1, two years after opening.
- Myojaku (Tokyo) — promoted to Three MICHELIN Stars in the 2026 guide.



WORLD SERVICE BENCHMARKS

The martini trolley ritual and the renaissance of iconic hotel bars.

KEY QUESTION

What do all №1 venues share — and can it be taught?

MODULE 6 · WEEKS 11-12

Budget Realisation & Scenography

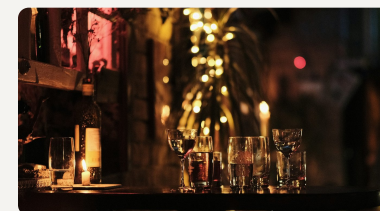
Opening something with soul without a large budget — then building it by hand, like stage scenery

TOPICS

- Soul before budget: a small budget is a creative brief, not a limitation.
- Sourcing discipline: flea markets, auctions, demolition yards, liquidations, the street.
- Repair, repurpose, re-upholster — patina is expensive to fake and free to keep.
- Scenography: painted flats, forced perspective, backdrops, scrim, one tight beam of light.
- Decorative techniques: trompe-l'œil, glazing, patina, stencil & gold leaf, faux bois / faux marbre.
- The fairy-tale test: a venue is a sweet fairy tale — any small detail can wake the guest up.
- Final exercise: a physical mockup of your own venue from paper and found materials (1:20 / 1:50).

CASES & FIELD MATERIAL

- Joi Espresso Bar — the course author's own project, assembled almost entirely from the street and flea markets.
- Himkok (Oslo) — a 200-year-old space reimaged instead of rebuilt; Best Bar Design.
- Handshake Speakeasy — hidden-door dramaturgy as stagecraft.



THE PAPER MOCKUP

Entrance, first sightline, light source and three atmosphere details — photographed at guest height.

KEY QUESTION

What can be found, reused or painted — and what genuinely has to be bought?

The ranking ecosystem

Four institutions the course is built on — and how they differ

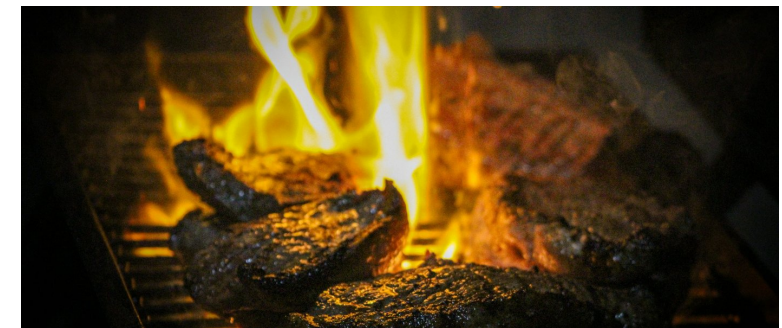
Institution	What it evaluates	Method	Status 2026
MICHELIN Guide	Cuisine quality & consistency	Anonymous inspectors; ★-★★★, Bib Gourmand, Green Star, special awards	City & country guides worldwide; 2026 reveals: Tokyo, California, Toronto
The 50 Best (The 50)	Restaurants & bars as experiences	Anonymous global academy; restaurants — 8 best experiences; bars — 600+ experts, 7 votes each	Restaurant ceremony: Lima, 4 Nov 2026; Bars 2026: 51-100 already revealed
GreatList	Best restaurants of global cities	100+ experts, anonymous visits, self-paid bills; criteria: food, service CJM, design, atmosphere	Russia, UAE, Qatar, Thailand, China; Singapore & Seoul coming soon
Diageo World Class	Bartending craft & innovation	National finals → global finals; 51 countries in 2025; expert jury of venue owners	16th season; winner 2025: Felice Capasso (Norway)

Case: The World's 50 Best Restaurants

Revealed in Turin, June 2025 — next chapter: Lima, 4 November 2026

#	Restaurant	City	#	Restaurant	City
1	Maido	Lima	6	Gaggan	Bangkok
2	Asador Etxebarri	Atxondo	7	Sézanne	Tokyo
3	Quintonil	Mexico City	8	Table by Bruno Verjus	Paris
4	DiverXO	Madrid	9	Kjolle	Lima
5	Alchemist	Copenhagen	10	Don Julio	Buenos Aires

- Latin America sets the tone: №1 and №3, plus four Lima venues in the top 50.
- Voters receive no formal criteria — they name their eight best experiences of the year.
- 2026 Art of Hospitality Award: Tuju (São Paulo) — service as radical personalisation.
- Class use: students predict the 2026 list before the Lima ceremony, then score themselves.



ASADOR ETXEBARRI · DON JULIO

Open fire and radical product minimalism at the top of the world list.

Case: The MICHELIN Guide

From tyre-maker's guide to the industry's most cited rating

— The star anatomy.

★ — very good cuisine; ★★ — worth a detour; ★★★ — worth a special journey; plus Bib Gourmand and special awards (Service, Sommelier, Young Chef).

— Tokyo 2026.

Myojaku promoted to Three Stars; 18 new stars; Service and Sommelier awards — the world's deepest starred scene.

— California 2026.

Californios becomes the first Mexican restaurant in the world with Three Stars.

— Sustainability & geopolitics.

Green Star transitions into «Mindful Voices». The Moscow chapter (debut 2021, suspended 2022) — a case study in rankings and geopolitics.



MICHELIN 2026 · CALIFORNIOS & MYOJAKU

Bespoke ceramic tableware, technical mastery, and regional identity at ★★★ level.

FIVE CRITERIA OF MICHELIN INSPECTORS

1. Quality of ingredients · 2. Mastery of cooking technique · 3. Harmony and clarity of flavours · 4. Personality of the chef in the dish · 5. Consistency across visits.

Case: The World's 50 Best Bars 2025

Ceremony in Hong Kong: for the first time, №1 goes to Asia

#	Bar	City	#	Bar	City
1	Bar Leone	Hong Kong	6	Connaught Bar	London
2	Handshake Speakeasy	Mexico City	7	Moebius Milano	Milan
3	Sips	Barcelona	8	Line	Athens
4	Paradiso	Barcelona	9	Jigger & Pony	Singapore
5	Tayēr + Elementary	London	10	Tres Monos	Buenos Aires

- Bar Leone: №1 only two years after opening — «cocktail popolari», classics without pretension.
- Best Bar Design: Himkok (Oslo) — sustainable reimagining of a 200-year-old space.
- Sustainable Bar: The Cambridge Public House (Paris); first-ever Best Bar in Africa (Hero Bar, Nairobi) and Middle East (Mimi Kakushi, Dubai).



BAR LEONE · COCKTAIL POPOLARI

A return to warm neighbourhood hospitality and unpretentious classic cocktails.

Cases: Diageo World Class & GreatList

People and expertise behind the headlines

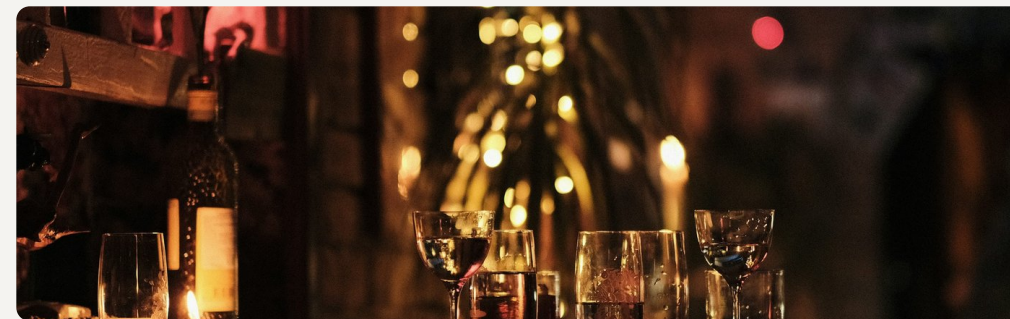
DIAGEO WORLD CLASS 2025 · TORONTO

- Winner: Felice Capasso (Norway) — Nedre Løkka Cocktailbar, Oslo; founder of Sesto Senso Academy.
- Challenges: reimagined classics with Johnnie Walker Black Label; Don Julio 1942 serve inspired by AI artwork; multisensory Singleton serve.
- Jury: Eric Van Beek (Handshake Speakeasy), Monica Berg (Tayēr + Elementary), Ago Perrone (Connaught Bar).



GREATLIST · INTERNATIONAL RESTAURANT GUIDE

- Founded 2022; 100+ experts; anonymous visits, self-paid bills, repeat visits at different hours.
- Criteria: food & chef imagination; service across the full CJM; design & ergonomics; atmosphere — from scent to music.
- Geography: Russia, Dubai, Doha, Bangkok, Hong Kong, Shanghai (+ Singapore & Seoul soon); GreatList Sessions guest dinners.



Teaching methodology

Every session: 45' lecture · 75' cases · 60' practice — plus the through-project «My Venue»

1

Case method on live venues

Maido, Bar Leone, Tuju, Himkok, Hanu — dissected as business systems: concept, economics, guest journey.

2

Sensory labs

Guided tastings testing neurogastronomy hypotheses: light, sound, weight, naming.

3

Atmosphere audits

Field teams evaluate Montreux & Riviera venues against GreatList-style criteria and present findings.

4

Guest speakers

Chefs, bartenders, restaurateurs and ranking experts — live or online, from the course's industry network.

5

Rankings war room

Real-time analysis of new lists — including the Lima ceremony of 4 November 2026.

6

5-minute reflection & peer review

5 minutes of silent individual notes before plenary debate; every «My Venue» page is peer-reviewed in pairs.

Practical core: «My Venue»

Every student builds their own bar or restaurant — from idea to «open & operate»

WEEK 1 · ASSIGNMENT 0

Each student presents their favourite bar or restaurant (5 min) through the course's four lenses — trends, design & atmosphere, senses, rankings. One change they would make as the owner.

Wk	Milestone of the student's own concept	Wk	Milestone of the student's own concept
2	Concept & USP; three world benchmarks	8	Operations & technology: service model, stack, human line
3	Trend memo: which trends the concept rides	9	AI & ethics page of the concept
4	Design & narrative: interior «three scenes», zoning	10	Marketing I: guest shifts & residencies, alcohol-brand partnerships, 90-day launch
5	Atmosphere spec + audit of a real Montreux venue	11	Marketing II: 3-year roadmap to a chosen guide or list
6	Three signature serves built on sensory effects	12	Final pitch «Open & Operate» before an expert panel
7	Menu architecture, pricing, an A/B test		

Format: one A4 page or two slides added every week; peer-reviewed in pairs. The folder of 11 pages becomes the final concept deck.

Assessment

Continuous, practice-based, industry-style

Component	Weight	What students do
Assignment 0 & participation	10%	Week-1 «favourite venue» talk; case discussions, war-room sessions
Field Notes (weekly)	15%	One-page weekly reviews: a venue visit, a ranking change, an industry article
«My Venue» weekly milestones	35%	Eleven weekly pages of the student's own concept; peer-reviewed
Final pitch «Open & Operate»	40%	Full concept deck plus a physical mockup of the venue (paper, cardboard, light — like stage scenery), defended before an expert panel

Grading follows HIM regulations. Late work policy and AI-use disclosure follow the institute's academic integrity rules.

Final pitch: «Open & Operate»

Each student's own venue: restaurant, bar, hotel F&B, pop-up — ready to open

01

USP & STORY

One-sentence USP, audience, price point — why the world should care.

02

DESIGN & ATMOSPHERE

Concept board: interior, light, sound, scent, tableware — managed senses.

03

MENU, BEVERAGE & OPERATIONS

Neurogastronomy-backed serves; service model, tech stack, unit-economics sketch.

04

MARKETING ENGINE

Guest shifts & chef residencies (GreatList Sessions model); alcohol-brand partnerships (World Class formats); 90-day launch plan.

05

MOCKUP & ROADMAP

A physical mockup of the venue — paper, cardboard, light, photographed at guest height — plus a 3-year plan to earn one target guide or list.

The panel includes invited industry professionals. The strongest concept is recommended for HIM student hospitality competitions and accelerator formats.

Fit with HIM & resources

The course extends the institute's ecosystem, not duplicates it

INTEGRATION WITH HIM

- Swiss hospitality tradition meets the global scene — the same duality HIM stands for.
- Montreux Jazz Festival field module: festival F&B; operations (HIM's long-standing partner).
- Connects to existing curriculum: marketing, revenue management, innovation, luxury business.
- Career bridge: students learn what world-class venues look for in managers and interns.

COURSE RESOURCES

- Live data: MICHELIN Guide reveals, The 50 rankings & stories, GreatList encyclopedia, World Class materials.
- Reading list: Guidara «Unreasonable Hospitality»; Meyer «Setting the Table»; Spence «Gastrophysics»; Pine & Gilmore «The Experience Economy».
- Video: The 50 films and Talks; ceremony livestreams.
- Guest network: alumni and industry contacts of the course author.

Week-by-week plan

12 sessions · each lesson has its own full prose & photo presentation deck

Wk	Session
1	Lesson 1. Introduction. Anatomy of contemporary Horeca. Rankings as industry infrastructure.
2	Lesson 2. Macro-trends I: experience economy 2.0, anti-luxury, casualization of fine dining.
3	Lesson 3. Macro-trends II: mindfulness, regional cuisines go global, gastro-tourism & hotel F&B.;
4	Lesson 4. Venue design: concept as narrative, architecture, interior, ergonomics (Prix Versailles; GreatList).
5	Lesson 5. Engineering atmosphere: light, sound, scent, tableware, service choreography. Field audit.
6	Lesson 6. Culinary science & neurogastronomy I: flavour chemistry, gastrophysics, sensory lab.
7	Lesson 7. Neurogastronomy II: menu psychology, pricing, peak-end design, World Class multisensory case.
8	Lesson 8. Technology I: reservations, revenue management, kitchen & floor automation, CRM.
9	Lesson 9. Technology II: AI in creativity and operations, Sesto Senso Academy, ethics & future of work.
10	Lesson 10. World restaurants & bars: chef philosophies (Noma et al.), MICHELIN, 50 Best, World Class, hotel bars.
11	Lesson 11. Budget realisation & scenography: sourcing with soul, theatrical decorative techniques (Joi Espresso Bar case).
12	Lesson 12. Mockup build + Final Pitch Day «Open & Operate»: concept deck defended together with a physical mockup.



CONTEMPORARY HORECA SCENE

Bring the world's best hospitality into the classroom.

Egor Tarasenko

Master in Business Management · Hotel Institute Montreux Alumnus

Montreux · 2026

Sources: MICHELIN Guide · The 50 Best · GreatList · Diageo World Class

